the wounded man who refuses to let the surgeon cut off his leg when he is told that amputation will probably save his life. They are apt to study in a superficial manner, without thoroughness, using scraps and smatterings of knowledge when even the most exact information is hardly sufficient.

Other reasons could be adduced, but they might be needless. A certain king excused the municipality of a town that neglected to fire a salute in his honor on their giving him the first one of fifty good reasons,—that they had no powder. The other forty-nine were suffered to remain undivulged. Enough reasons have been given here to explain why so many people fail to study the stock market successfully.

But while it is very easy to pick to pieces the various systems that are sure to win on the stock exchange, and to criticise the methods of study of the prejudiced, it is most difficult to lay down absolute rules for the successful study of the share market. One invariable rule there is, but it requires large capital and patience to practise it. It is this: Buy only what you can pay for; buy when cheap and sell when dear. The veriest financial infants can see the force of this.

Yet even this precept has its weak points. For instance, how is a person to be absolutely certain that a given stock is cheap or dear at a given time? You say, by comparison? But if he compares the price with what it was at any past period, he must also be able to state all the facts that existed, at that period having any bearing on this stock, and since these facts may run into the thousands as to number, and into all parts of the country as to place, our learner has a heavy contract on hand. Then, too, he must bring to bear a clear judgment, and a resolution such as soldiers exercise when they charge batteries, and he must be prepared next day to find out that he was wrong. After a careful and exhaustive search into all the materials at hand, he buys shares at, say, 60 per cent. of par, as being cheap at the price, and really worth more money, and next day they may be offered at 50. He then has really lost $10 on each share; but if he holds the purchase,